SWEN303 ASSIGNMENT 3 INTERVIEW Q&A

Caleb: 22 year old comp sci and data science student in 2nd year - wants to work in a team developing cyber technologies

Q: Tell me about a group project you worked on previously (or this one), what was it for, and how big was the group?
A: making a robot to follow a path and there were 6 people

Q: Walk me through how your group first got organised, what tools did your group decide to use, who decided what gets used, and why did you choose them?
A: Found each other at a lab as it was randomly assigned, read and allocated parts of the task, they used messenger, gitlab, discord, text, and email, because people all used different things. People just used what they wanted to use. Wrote report in google drive.

Q: How much of the tools you use are provided by your university (GitLab, Canvas) versus externally (Discord, Google Docs, GitHub etc)?
A: Gitlab, outlook. Externally, text, messenger, discord, google drive

Q: Tell me about the last time your group needed to share or edit a document together. What did you actually use, and how did that go? Was it convenient?
A: Google drive, everyone downloaded and changed the same thing and they ended up doing the same thing. There wasnt any way to do the 3d software stuff colloaboratively and people got confused with who was doing what. Not convenient.

Q: How did you group manage to keep track of who was doing what?
A: Didn’t really, attempted to use a shared doc, but people didnt update it and it got outdated.

Q: Tell me about a time group coordination went badly. What happened, and how did it make you feel?
A: Same as last

Q: Has there been a time a tool(s) you were using (Git, Docs, Discord, whatever) got in the way rather than helped. What happened?
A: Same as last again

Q: Has the **amount** of external tools required for a project ever felt inconvenient or overwhelming? How so, and what did you do to manage?
A: Yes, there were so many different tools required, things got lost in translation, work got done twice and lost because different people were doing different things in different places.

Q: Would you prefer if there were less degrees of separation between the platforms? / Which tools or tool features from past projects do you wish would have been integrated, and more accessible?
A: Yes, shared tracking of tasks completed, a 3d modeling system thats consistently used throughout the degree and integrated in some way.

Q: Was there a moment you felt out of the loop on what your group had done? Tell me about it.
A: Yes, docs werent getting updated, there was no centralised communication, so some people knew more than others.

Q: Is there a habit your group settled into for staying coordinated (e.g. weekly in person meeting, Discord server)? How did that start and did you have to rely on tools outside of uni?
A: Not really, it was just disorganised until the last minute where we had to combine and fill in the gaps.

Q: Tell me about the last time your group submitted a project. Walk me through that process, step by step. Was it as convenient as a one-button submission or did you have to round up files from different external sources (Google Docs, GitHub, IntelliJ)?
A: There were multiple different files from different places, and we needed to send them all to one person as they needed to be submitted all as one, until it was sent, we didn't really know what was missing.

Q: Did your group ever get stuck and need help (i.e from a tutor or lecturer)? What did you do?
A: Reached out for help in labs, mostly just help with technical stuff, hard to know what was done outside of labs, people only shared as a group in person.

Q: How did that compare to how you'd ask for help on solo work?
A: Can reach out any time and know exactly what you needed help with, could also use ai models to help with smaller technical questions. Disorganisation isnt as much of an issue alone.

Q: As a whole, would you say you’re satisfied with the way group projects are ran through university?
A: Absolutely not, i dont think anyone would say yes, we need to sort it all externally, I didnt know about the group Canvas page until i was told about it now. Theres nothing

like that with the current system.

Q: Is there anything about working in groups at uni that's been a problem that I haven't asked about?
A: Nah